

Answer Key

Grammar

Past Perfect (had + past participle)

We form the Past Perfect with had + the past participle of the verb. We use it for an action that happened before a specific past time, or before another past action.

Past Perfect, had + fiilin üçüncü hali (past participle) ile oluşturulur. Belirli bir geçmiş zamandan önce ya da geçmişteki başka bir olaydan önce gerçekleşen bir eylemi anlatmak için kullanılır.

When? We use the Past Perfect to show the earlier of two past actions, often with time markers like 'before', 'after', 'already', 'by the time', 'when' and 'never...before'.

İki geçmiş eylemden daha önce gerçekleşeni belirtmek için Past Perfect kullanılır; genellikle 'before', 'after', 'already', 'by the time', 'when' ve 'never...before' gibi zaman ifadeleriyle birlikte kullanılır.

Positive

- She had finished the report before the meeting started.
- They had already left when we arrived.

Negative

- He had not seen the message before he replied.
- We hadn't visited that city before last summer.

Question

- Had you finished your homework before dinner?
- Had she ever travelled abroad before that trip?

Short answers

- Yes, I had. / No, I hadn't.
- Yes, she had. / No, she hadn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~When I arrived, the film already started.~~ → **When I arrived, the film had already started.**
- ~~She had went to Paris before she moved to London.~~ → **She had gone to Paris before she moved to London.**
- ~~By the time he was twenty, he lived in three countries.~~ → **By the time he was twenty, he had lived in three countries.**

1. By the time she was eighteen, she _____ (travel) to five different countries. **(had travelled / had traveled)**

Earlier past action before a past time marker.

2. Choose the correct sentence.

- a. When we got home, it started to rain.
- b. When we got home, it had started to rain. ✓
- c. When we got home, it has started to rain.
- d. When we got home, it starts to rain.

The rain started before we got home, so we need the Past Perfect.

3. She had never met him before that party. — True / False **(Correct)**

4. He _____ his keys, so he couldn't get into the house.

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- a. lost
 - b. had lost ✓
 - c. loses
 - d. has lost

Losing the keys happened before he tried to get in, so we use the Past Perfect.

5. Put the words in order: (already / the / had / bus / left / when / I arrived)

The bus had already left when I arrived.

6. _____ you ever _____ (be) to that museum before last week's trip? **(Had, been)**

Question form of the Past Perfect: Had + subject + past participle.

7. Combine using the Past Perfect: The train left. I got to the station five minutes later. *(By the time...)* **The train had left by the time I got to the station. / When I got to the station, the train had already left.**

8. Which sentence uses the Past Perfect correctly?

- a. I hadn't eaten anything before the show start.
- b. I hadn't eaten anything before the show started. ✓
- c. I don't eaten anything before the show started.
- d. I not ate anything before the show started.

Both clauses need correct tense: 'had not eaten' (Past Perfect) and 'started' (Simple Past).

9. Rewrite as one sentence using the Past Perfect: She finished her project. Then she went to bed. *(After...)* **She had finished her project before she went to bed. / After she had finished her project, she went to bed.**

10. The city _____ completely (change) by the time she returned after twenty years abroad. **(had changed)**

The change happened before her return, so we use the Past Perfect.

11. Choose the best continuation: 'By the time the film finished, most of the audience...'

- a. fell asleep.
- b. had fallen asleep. ✓
- c. falls asleep.
- d. has fallen asleep.

Falling asleep happened before the film finished, so we need the Past Perfect.

Past Perfect with time expressions (before, after, already, by the time, never...before)

Time expressions such as 'before', 'after', 'already', 'by the time' and 'never...before' are often used with the Past Perfect to make the sequence of past events clear.

'Before', 'after', 'already', 'by the time' ve 'never...before' gibi zaman ifadeleri, geçmişteki olayların sırasını netleştirmek için genellikle Past Perfect ile birlikte kullanılır.

When? We choose the time expression depending on which action we want to highlight as earlier, and we combine it with the Past Perfect for that earlier action.

Hangi eylemin daha önce gerçekleştiğini vurgulamak istediğimize göre zaman ifadesini seçeriz ve bu daha önceki eylemi Past Perfect ile birleştiririz.

Positive

- By the time ~~we got there, the snow had already~~ begun.
- After she had finished her studies, she started working.

Negative

- ~~Before the interview, he hadn't prepared any~~ questions.
- By the time I called, they hadn't left yet.

Question

- Had you ever visited that country before your trip last year?
- By the time you got home, had your family already eaten?

Short answers

- Yes, I had. / No, I hadn't.
- Yes, they had. / No, they hadn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~By the time she arrived, we finish the cake.~~ → **By the time she arrived, we had finished the cake.**
- ~~It was the first time I have seen snow.~~ → **It was the first time I had seen snow.**
- ~~After she had arrived home, she was calling her mother.~~ → **After she had arrived home, she called her mother.**

1. _____ the time she called, I _____ (already leave) the office. **(By, had already left)**

'By the time' + Past Perfect shows the earlier completed action.

2. It was the first time he _____ a live concert.

- a. saw
- b. had seen ✓
- c. has seen
- d. sees

'It was the first time...' takes the Past Perfect.

3. After they had eaten dinner, they went for a walk. — True / False **(Correct)**

4. Join using 'before': She locked the door. Then she left the house. **She had locked the door before she left the house. / Before she left the house, she had locked the door.**

5. Choose the correct sentence.

- a. Never before I had travelled so far.
- b. I had never travelled so far before. ✓
- c. I have never travelled so far before that.
- d. I never had travelled so far before.

Standard word order: subject + had + never + past participle + before.

6. Combine with 'by the time': The guests left. We hadn't cleaned the kitchen yet. **By the time the guests left, we hadn't cleaned the kitchen. / We hadn't cleaned the kitchen by the time the guests left.**

7. It was the first time she _____ (be) responsible for organising an event on her own. **(had been)**

'It was the first time...' + Past Perfect.

The Teacher Who Never Gave Up

Before you read

- Look at the title. What kind of life story do you expect to read?
- Have you ever heard of someone who overcame great hardship to succeed?

By the time Elif turned forty, she had already achieved something that few people from her small village had ever managed: she had become the headteacher of the region's largest school. But her path there had not been easy.

Elif had grown up in a mountain village where, at the time, few girls had continued their education beyond primary school. Her parents had never gone to secondary school themselves, but they had always believed that education could change their daughter's future. By the time she was twelve, Elif had already decided that she wanted to become a teacher, even though nobody in her family had ever worked in education before.

After she had finished secondary school in the nearest town, she had to travel two hours by bus every day to attend university. She later said that by the time she graduated, she had missed countless family events and had faced financial hardship that had tested her more than once. Still, she had never given up on her goal.

Her first teaching post had been in a small rural school that had not had enough books or equipment. Elif had spent her own savings buying materials for her students. Within a few years, word of her dedication had spread, and by the time a position opened at the regional school, she had already built a reputation as one of the most resilient teachers in the area.

Today, when Elif looks back, she says that everything she had gone through had shaped the teacher she eventually became. Her story has become an inspiration for many young people in her village who now believe that, like her, they too can overcome hardship and reach their own milestones.

1. What had Elif achieved by the time she turned forty?
- a. She had opened her own school.
 - b. She had become the headteacher of the region's largest school. ✓
 - c. She had written a book about education.
 - d. She had moved to a different country.

The text states she had become the headteacher of the region's largest school.

2. Elif's parents had studied at secondary school themselves. — True / False **(Incorrect — Elif's parents had never gone to secondary school themselves.)**

3. By the time she was twelve, Elif had already _____ that she wanted to become a teacher. **(decided)**

The text says she had already decided by the age of twelve.

4. What had Elif done with her own savings?
- a. She had bought a house.
 - b. She had paid for her university fees.
 - c. She had bought materials for her students. ✓
 - d. She had donated them to her village.

The text says she had spent her own savings buying materials for her students.

5. Explain in your own words why Elif's journey to becoming a teacher had not been easy. (*Elif's journey had not been easy because...*) **She had to travel long distances, missed family events, and faced financial hardship before finishing university.**

After you read

- Do you know anyone whose life story resembles Elif's? What made them resilient?
- What milestone would you like to have achieved by the time you are forty?

A Return to the Abandoned House

Before you read

- Predict: why might someone want to return to a place they lived in as a child?
- What feelings do old, abandoned places often create?

When Kerem parked his car in front of the old house, he felt a wave of nostalgia. He had not visited the place since his family had relocated to the city twenty years earlier, and by the time he got out of the car, memories he had almost forgotten had already begun to return.

The house looked very different from how he remembered it. The garden his grandfather had once carefully looked after had become overgrown, and the walls, which had been painted a bright blue when he was a child, were now faded and cracked. Someone had clearly abandoned the property years before, and nature had slowly taken it back.

Kerem walked through what had once been the kitchen. He recalled that his grandmother had always been cooking something there, and the smell of fresh bread had filled the whole house every morning. He remembered that, before he had even woken up, she had usually already prepared breakfast for the whole family.

In the corner of the main room, Kerem found an old wooden chest that his family had left behind when they had moved. Inside, he discovered photographs that had faded over the decades, along with a notebook his grandfather had written in. As he read the pages, he realised how much of his family's history he had never known before that moment.

Kerem left the house that afternoon feeling that, although the building had changed completely, the memories it held had not faded at all. He decided that he would come back again soon, this time bringing his own children so they could learn about the place their family had once called home.

1. How long had it been since Kerem had visited the house?
- a. Ten years
 - b. Fifteen years
 - c. Twenty years ✓
 - d. Thirty years

The text states his family had relocated twenty years earlier.

2. The garden had been well cared for by the time Kerem returned. — True / False **(Incorrect — The garden had become overgrown by the time Kerem returned.)**

3. Before Kerem had even woken up, his grandmother had usually already _____ breakfast. **(prepared)**

The text says she had usually already prepared breakfast before he woke up.

4. What did Kerem find in the old wooden chest?

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- ☐ a. Old clothes and toys
- ☒ b. Photographs and a notebook ✓
- ☐ c. Money and jewellery
- ☐ d. Letters and a map

The text mentions faded photographs and a notebook his grandfather had written in.

5. In your own words, explain what Kerem decided to do at the end of the story and why. (*At the end, Kerem decided...*) **He decided to bring his own children to the house so they could learn about their family's past.**

After you read

- Have you ever returned to a place from your childhood? What had changed?
- Why do you think old family objects, like photographs or notebooks, matter to people?

Catching Up After Many Years

Before you listen

- What do old friends usually talk about when they meet after a long time?
- Predict two things the speakers might mention that had happened before they met again.

1. Why hadn't A and B seen each other?

- a. They had had an argument.
- b. They had lost contact since finishing university. ✓
- c. They had moved to different countries permanently.
- d. They had never actually met before.

A says they hadn't seen each other since they had finished university.

2. Before getting her current job, A had worked abroad for three years. — True / False **(Correct)**

3. By the time she left, A had actually _____ a new language too. **(learned)**

A mentions that by the time she left, she had learned a new language.

4. What had B already started by the time he turned thirty?

- a. A new job
- b. A family
- c. His own small business ✓
- d. A university course

B says that by the time he turned thirty, he had already started his own small business.

Transcript (teacher use)

A I can't believe it's really you! We hadn't seen each other since we had finished university.

B I know! By the time I moved back to this city, I had already lost your number, so I couldn't even message you.

A So much has happened. Before I got this job, I had worked abroad for three years.

B Really? I hadn't heard that. What had you been doing there?

A I had been teaching English in a small school. By the time I left, I had actually learned a new language too.

B That's amazing. I had never expected you to travel that far from home.

A Neither had I, honestly! What about you? Had anything changed for you?

B Well, by the time I turned thirty, I had already started my own small business, which had always been my dream.

A That's wonderful. It seems like we had both been busy building our own paths before we finally reunited today.

A Grandmother's Story

Before you listen

- What kinds of stories do grandparents often tell about their own past?

- Listen for the order of events in the grandmother's life.

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1. What had the grandmother already done by the age of eighteen?

- a. Got married
- b. Left her home town to study ✓
- c. Started working as an engineer
- d. Had children

The narrator says by eighteen, she had already left her home town to study.

2. The grandmother had known the grandfather for many years before they married. — True / False **(Incorrect)**
— **They had known each other for only a few months before they decided to get married.)**

3. By the time they celebrated their first anniversary, they had already _____ three times. **(relocated)**

The narrator states they had already relocated three times by their first anniversary.

4. According to the story, what had shaped the grandmother into a resilient person?

- a. Her university studies
- b. All her different experiences moving to new cities ✓
- c. Her career as an engineer
- d. Her time as a teacher

The narrator says all those experiences had made her more resilient and open-minded.

Transcript (teacher use)

Narrator By the time my grandmother was eighteen, she had already left her home town to study in a bigger city.

Narrator Before she had even finished her studies, she had met my grandfather, who had been working there as an engineer.

Narrator They had known each other for only a few months when they decided to get married.

Narrator By the time they celebrated their first anniversary, they had already relocated three times because of my grandfather's work.

Narrator My grandmother once told me that, before she had turned twenty-five, she had lived in more cities than most people visit in a lifetime.

Narrator She said that all those experiences had made her a more resilient and open-minded person by the time she finally settled down.

Revision

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1. By the time the movie started, we _____ our snacks.

- a. buy
- b. bought
- c. had bought ✓
- d. have bought

Buying the snacks happened before the movie started, an earlier past action.

2. It was the first time she _____ (visit) a big city on her own. **(had visited)**

'It was the first time...' is followed by the Past Perfect.

3. Before he called me, he had already sent an email. — True / False **(Correct)**

4. What is the correct meaning of 'milestone' in this theme's context?

- a. A type of road sign
- b. An important achievement or point in life ✓
- c. A kind of old building
- d. A short holiday

'Milestone' means an important stage or achievement.

5. The house looked _____ because no one had lived in it for years. (use 'abandoned') **(abandoned)**

'Abandoned' describes a place that has been left empty.

6. According to 'The Teacher Who Never Gave Up', what had Elif done before a position opened at the regional school?

- a. She had studied abroad.
- b. She had already built a reputation as a dedicated teacher. ✓
- c. She had written a textbook.
- d. She had retired from teaching.

The text says she had already built a reputation as one of the most resilient teachers.

7. In the listening 'Catching Up After Many Years', B had already started his own business by the time he turned thirty. — True / False **(Correct)**

8. Combine using the Past Perfect: She finished her degree. Then she found a job. **She had finished her degree before she found a job. / After she had finished her degree, she found a job.**

9. Which sentence correctly describes an earlier past action?

- a. When I got there, the train already left.
- b. When I got there, the train had already left. ✓
- c. When I got there, the train leaves already.
- d. When I got there, the train has already left.

The train leaving happened before 'I got there', so Past Perfect is required.

10. Put the words in order: (never / before / that / had / I / tried / food)

I had never tried that food before.

Altın Çağ İngilizce Öğretmeni — 11. Sınıf — Answer Key · Orijinal içerik, TYMM müfredatıyla uyumlu.

1. Choose the correct meaning of 'eventually'.

- a. immediately
- b. in the end, after some time ✓
- c. never
- d. usually

'Eventually' means something happened after a period of time.

2. She felt _____ when she looked at old photos of her childhood home. (use a word meaning 'full of longing for the past') **(nostalgic)**

'Nostalgic' describes a feeling of longing for the past.

3. Which word best fits: 'They had to _____ great hardship before they succeeded.'

- a. overcome ✓
- b. witness
- c. recall
- d. relocate

'Overcome hardship' is the correct collocation.

1. By the time we arrived, the concert _____ (already start). **(had already started)**

Earlier past action before another past action.

2. Choose the correct question form.

- a. Had you ever visit Paris before?
- b. Have you ever visited Paris before?
- c. Had you ever visited Paris before? ✓
- d. Did you had visited Paris before?

Correct Past Perfect question: Had + subject + past participle.

3. I hadn't finished my homework when my friend arrived. — True / False **(Correct)**

4. Combine: The rain stopped. We left the house. **The rain had stopped before we left the house. / By the time we left the house, the rain had stopped.**

1. In 'A Return to the Abandoned House', what had happened to the garden by the time Kerem returned?

- a. It had been replanted.
- b. It had become overgrown. ✓
- c. It had been destroyed by fire.
- d. It had stayed exactly the same.

The text says the garden had become overgrown.

2. Kerem found an old wooden chest that his family had left behind when they had _____. **(moved)**

The text says the chest was left when the family had moved.

1. In 'A Grandmother's Story', what had the grandmother done before finishing her studies?

- a. She had got married.
- b. She had met the grandfather. ✓
- c. She had moved abroad.
- d. She had started a business.

The narrator says before she had even finished her studies, she had met the grandfather.

2. The grandparents had relocated three times by their first anniversary. — True / False **(Correct)**